A-A-53709
30 September 1988

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT AND DRESSING

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this Commercial Item Description.

This Commercial Item Description covers two types of portable tabletop steam sterilizers for use in medical and dental offices, medical laboratories and clinics.

The sterilizer shall be one of the following types:

Type I. Portable tabletop steam sterilizer as described herein.

Type II. Same as Type I except shall provide a 12 hour chart recorder for documentation of time and temperature for every cycle.

Salient characteristics:

The steam sterilizer shall be a portable, round or square chambered, electrically-powered, tabletop unit with nominal outside dimensions of 13 to 16 inches (33.0 to 40.6 cm) wide by 17 to 18 inches (43.2 to 45.7 cm) high by 20 to 24 inches (50.8 to 61.0 cm) deep. The square chamber shall be approximately 8 inches (20.3 cm) square by 16 inches (40.6 cm) deep and shall have three trays. The round chamber shall be approximately 10 inches (25.4 cm) in diameter by 15-1/2 inches (39.4 cm) deep and shall have at least two trays and a rack.

The sterilizer shall have the operating controls in front, convenient to use. Controls shall include the following:

a. A combined temperature and pressure indicator, or separate temperature and pressure indicators accurate to within ± 2°F (± 1°C). The indicators shall have minimum ranges of 210°F to 280°F (99°C. to 138°C.) and 0 to 60 psi (0 to 4.22 Kpa).

b. An adjustable temperature controller.

c. A visible means of indicating when the sterilizer is in the exposure and timing phase.

AMSC N/A FSC 6530

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d. A cycle timer with a minimum setting of 3 to 90 minutes and accuracy up to 5 percent is acceptable.

e. A means shall be provided to indicate if the unit drops below the set temperature during the exposure phase.

The sterilizer shall provide and automatically maintain sterilizing temperatures within the range of 250°F (121°C) to 270°F (132°C), accurate to + 4°F -0°F (+ 2°C, -0°C). A safety valve set to vent steam at 33 psig (2.32 Kpa) in the square chamber and 45 psig (2.81 Kpa) in the round chamber, shall be provided. The sterilizing vessel shall meet the applicable requirements of ASME. The safety valve shall also provide a safe means of manually releasing steam. A manually or automatically controlled drying cycle shall be provided for, following the sterilization cycle.

The sterilizer shall have a chamber door mechanism that will offer resistance to the user such that the door cannot be opened until chamber pressure is vented and reduced to zero. As an alternate, it shall be necessary to manually activate the chamber exhaust vent before the door latch can be released. The chamber and trays shall be corrosion-resisting metal. A corrosion-resisting water reservior, with a capacity sufficient for at least 10 sterilization cycles, shall be provided. There shall be a means of draining water from the reservoir. The sterilizer shall be rendered inoperative when water is not present in the chamber.

The sterilizer shall be capable of sterilizing liquids with little water loss by means of a slow exhaust cycle.

Performance. The sterilizer shall be capable of at least ten complete sterilization cycles on one filling of the reservoir. The sterilizer shall kill 100 percent of spores on test strips when tested as specified herein. The sterilizer shall pass the operation test specified herein.

The sterilizer shall meet the applicable requirements of Underwriter's Laboratories UL 544 "Standard for Safety, Medical and Dental Equipment".

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The sterilizer shall operate on 120/230 volts, 50/60 Hz, AC and be furnished with a 3-conductor power cord at least 6 feet (1.83 m) in length. Labeling shall consist of the manufacturer's name and serial number. Operator and maintenance manuals shall be provided with each unit.

Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. The sterilizer shall be free from defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One sterilizer with instructions for operation and maintenance as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

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Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an inspection level of II. The unit of product for sampling purposes shall be one complete sterilizer as specified in this description.

Defects.

Any component missing, broken, or otherwise unusable.

Service data missing or incomplete.

Plumbing not properly routed, not interchangeable from unit to unit, not free of kinks or flattened areas.

Welding not continuous, not free of voids, holes, or cracks.

12-hour chart recorder not provided on type II sterilizer.

Trays and rack not supplied as required herein.

Finish not free of scratches and discoloration.

Sterilizer does not rest evenly on a flat surface.

Nameplate missing, incomplete, illegible.

Plumbing connections not correct not clean, not first class.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests, including dimensional test, shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 2.5 (percent defective) and inspection level of S-3. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one sterilizer.

Tests.

Spore kill. The first article sample shall be operated at 250°F. for 15 minutes and at 270°F. for 3 minutes. Two sterilization test strips shall be used to determine efficiency at the two temperature settings. A spore strip from the same lot shall be retained as a viability control. Testing for spore kill shall be as recommended in the U.S. Pharmacopeia.

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Operation. Each sterilizer shall be operated in accordance with the manufacturer's instructions to determine compliance with requirements herein.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

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NOTE: The following National Stock Numbers are covered by this document:

Type I - 6530-01-049-0427
Type II - 6530-01-134-3711

Ordering data. Intermediate/exterior package quantities, labeling, and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order.

The sterilizer test strip reference herein is under NSN 6530-00-477-6720.

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

PREPARING ACTIVITY:

DoD - MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

Project No. 6530-1960

PGC H1097

Location: CID/STERILIZER/H11-25

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STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1 DOCUMENT NUMBER	2 DOCUMENT TITLE
A-A-53709	STERILIZER, SURGICAL INSTRUMENT AND DRESSING

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4 TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
	☐ USER
b ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)*	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*

5 PROBLEM AREAS

a Paragraph Number and Wording

b Recommended Wording

c Reason/Rationale for Recommendation

6 REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last First MI)* – Optional	b WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c MAILING ADDRESS *(Street City State ZIP Code)* – Optional	8 DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

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NOTE This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements.

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